🎁 Free Trial Feature — Full Specification

Developer-Ready Functional Specification (Markdown)

Scope: Trial Activation, Trial States, Trial Expiration, Upgrade Flow, Restrictions, Notifications, Edge Cases

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1. Overview

The Free Trial feature allows new salons to use the platform with **full functionality** for a limited time (e.g., 14 or 30 days) before requiring a paid subscription.

The trial is designed to:

- Reduce onboarding friction
- Increase sign-ups
- Allow salons to experience value before paying
- Support viral growth (founding salon offers, referrals)
- Convert high-intent users into paying customers

The trial **does not** affect Stripe Connect or client payments.
Salons can accept deposits, cancellation fees, and payouts during the trial.

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2. Trial Concepts

2.1 Trial Duration

Configurable:

- Default: **14 days** or **30 days**
- Founding salons: **60–90 days**
- Referral bonus: +7 to +30 days

2.2 Trial States

- `not_started` — salon has not completed onboarding
- `active` — trial is running
- `expiring_soon` — X days left (default: 3)
- `expired` — trial ended, subscription required
- `upgraded` — salon subscribed before trial ended

2.3 Trial Activation Trigger

Trial begins when:

- Salon completes onboarding **AND**
- Salon activates their booking link (or completes Stripe Connect)

This ensures trial time isn't wasted during setup.

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3. Trial Activation Flow

Step 1 — Salon completes onboarding

Required:

- Business profile
- Services
- Availability
- Policies
- Stripe Connect (optional but recommended)

Step 2 — System activates free trial

Salon sees:

> 🎉 **Your free trial has started!**
> You have **14 days** of full access.

Step 3 — Trial countdown begins

Dashboard shows:

- Days remaining
- Upgrade CTA
- Benefits of upgrading

Step 4 — Booking link becomes active

Salon can:

- Accept bookings
- Accept payments
- Appear in marketplace (if enabled)

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4. What Salons Can Do During the Trial

During the free trial, salons have **full access** to:

Core features

- Booking
- Calendar
- Services
- Staff
- Clients
- Policies

- Availability

Payments

- Deposits
- Cancellation fees
- Remaining balance charges
- Tips
- Payouts
- Refunds

Marketplace

- Visible in marketplace
- Can post content
- Can receive new clients

Messaging

- Chat with clients
- Automated reminders

Analytics

- Basic analytics
- Marketplace analytics

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5. What Happens When Trial Ends

When the trial expires:

5.1 Booking is disabled

- Clients cannot book new appointments
- Booking link shows:

> “This salon is not accepting online bookings right now.”

5.2 Marketplace profile hidden

- Salon removed from discovery feed
- Posts hidden
- Direct profile link shows:

> “This salon is currently inactive.”

5.3 Existing appointments remain active

Salon can still:

- View appointments

- Complete appointments
- Charge remaining balances
- Issue refunds

5.4 Payments still work

Stripe Connect continues to:

- Charge clients
- Send payouts
- Handle refunds

5.5 Dashboard shows upgrade prompt

Banner:

> "Your free trial has ended. Subscribe to reactivate bookings."

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6. Upgrade Flow (Trial → Paid)

Step 1 — Salon clicks "Upgrade"

From:

- Dashboard banner
- Settings → Subscription
- Trial countdown widget

Step 2 — Choose plan

Plans:

- Solo
- Team
- Multi-location
- Add-ons (optional)

Step 3 — Enter payment method

- Credit card
- Apple Pay / Google Pay (optional)

Step 4 — Subscription activated

- Booking re-enabled
- Marketplace visibility restored
- Trial state becomes `upgraded`

Step 5 — Confirmation screen

> "Your subscription is active. Your booking link is live again."

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7. Notifications & Reminders

7.1 Trial Start

- In-app banner
- Email: “Welcome to your free trial!”

7.2 Trial Progress

- Day 7 (for 14-day trial)
- Day 15 (for 30-day trial)

7.3 Trial Expiring Soon

Sent at:

- 3 days left
- 1 day left

Message:

> “Your trial ends soon. Upgrade to keep your booking link active.”

7.4 Trial Expired

- In-app banner
- Email: “Your trial has ended — reactivate your booking link.”

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8. Edge Cases & Special Scenarios

8.1 Salon Does Not Complete Onboarding

- Trial does **not** start
- Dashboard shows:

  > “Finish onboarding to start your free trial.”

8.2 Salon Completes Onboarding but Skips Stripe Connect

- Trial starts
- Booking enabled
- Payments disabled
- Banner:

  > “Set up payments to accept deposits and fees.”

8.3 Salon Upgrades Before Trial Ends

- Trial ends early
- Subscription begins immediately

- No double billing

8.4 Salon Downgrades Plan

- Allowed anytime
- Changes apply next billing cycle

8.5 Salon Cancels Subscription After Trial

- Booking disabled
- Marketplace hidden
- Data retained

8.6 Founding Salon Extended Trial

- Custom trial duration
- Special badge (optional)
- Early adopter perks

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9. Non-Functional Requirements

- Trial countdown must be accurate to the minute
- All trial states must persist across devices
- Trial must not block Stripe Connect flows
- Trial must not block payouts
- Trial expiration must be idempotent (no double disabling)
- All trial-related UI must be mobile-first

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10. Admin Controls

Admins can:

- Extend trial
- Shorten trial
- Restart trial (rare)
- View trial history
- Apply founding salon perks

✅ Free Trial Feature Spec Complete